

Literary ANALYSIS

Learning Objective & Contents

Use this template to:

- Critically analyse a studied literary text
- Consider its meaning, construction and impact
- Use evidence and literary terminology to support your interpretations

This literary analysis template includes the following sections:

- Key Details
- Context
- Themes and Ideas
- Characterisation
- Setting
- Narrative voice
- Structure and form
- Literary devices
- Personal response



Key Details

Text title	
Author	
Date of publication	

Genre and form	

Context

Authorial Context	Influence
Notes about the author's background, life experiences, style, values or purpose	How these have shaped the characters, events, themes or perspectives in the text

Context of Production	Influence
Notes about the historical, cultural, social or political context of the time the text was written or produced	How these have shaped specific elements within the studied text

Themes & Ideas

Identify 2-3 major themes (e.g., identity, justice, power, belonging). Write these as theme statements (a comment the text makes about each theme). Then, note down some of the author's choices in textual elements that helped to communicate those themes.

Theme	Theme Statement	Textual Elements
E.g. Power	The text explores the idea that... • Power can corrupt individuals when left unchecked. • Resistance against oppressive power can lead to personal growth and change. • True power often lies in knowledge, not force.	Genre - dystopian novel Characterisation of protagonist and supporting characters Person vs. government conflict Symbolism of books

Characterisation

Character 1

Character name	
Role (e.g. protagonist, antagonist, narrator)	
Key traits or personality aspects	• • •
Values and/or attitudes represented	
Development or Transformation How does the character change (or stay the same) throughout the text?	
Relationships and Interactions How does this character relate to others, and what do these relationships reveal?	
Symbolic or Thematic Role What ideas, values, or themes does this character represent?	

Key Quotations and Analysis			
Quotation	**Technique/s used**	**What it reveals about the character**	**Link to themes and ideas**

Character 2

Character name	
Role (e.g. protagonist, antagonist, narrator)	
Key traits or personality aspects	• • •
Values and/or attitudes represented	
Development or Transformation How does the character change (or stay the same) throughout the text?	
Relationships and Interactions How does this character relate to others, and what do these relationships reveal?	
Symbolic or Thematic Role What ideas, values, or themes does this character represent?	

Key Quotations and Analysis			
Quotation	**Technique/s used**	**What it reveals about the character**	**Link to themes and ideas**

Setting

Primary setting	
Time Period or Historical Context	
Description of the setting Briefly describe the physical, social, or emotional setting(s). These can include both macro and micro settings	
Mood or atmosphere	
Symbolic Significance Does the setting represent or symbolise an idea, value, or theme?	
Influence on Plot and Characters How does the setting affect character decisions, relationships, or events?	

Key Quotations and Analysis			
Quotation	**Technique /s used**	**Effect / Mood Created**	**Link to theme or character**

Narrative Voice

Narrator Type (first person, third person limited/omniscient, etc.)	
Narrator's Identity or Relationship to Events • Whose point of view is the story told from? • Is the narrator involved in the events, or observing from outside? • How does this influence what the reader knows or doesn't know?	
Perspective and Reliability • Is the narrator reliable or biased? Provide evidence. • How does the narrator's perspective shape how characters or events are presented?	
Voice and Tone • What kind of voice is used (e.g. formal, ironic, conversational, poetic)? • How does this voice reflect the narrator's personality or values?	
Effect on the Reader • How does the narrative voice position the reader (e.g. sympathetic, sceptical, reflective)? • How does the voice support the author's message or theme?	

Key Quotations and Analysis			
Quotation	**Technique/s used**	**Effect / Insight**	**Link to theme or character**

Structure and Form

Form of the Text • What is the form or genre (e.g. novel, short story, play, poem, memoir)? • Are there any hybrid forms or genre conventions used or subverted?	
Overall Structure • How is the text organised (e.g. linear, non-linear, cyclical, fragmented)? • How does this affect the pacing, tone, and unfolding of ideas?	
Key Structural Features Tick any that apply and explain their effect in the space below	☐ Prologue and/or Epilogue ☐ Flashbacks ☐ Flashforward ☐ Foreshadowing ☐ Dual timelines ☐ Dual narrators ☐ Framed narrative ☐ Vignettes ☐ Repetition or motif ☐ Shifts in time or place ☐ Cliffhangers or other suspense devices ☐ Other

Beginning	**Ending**
Note down key details about the beginning of the text. Why is it significant? How does the opening engage the reader and set up the story?	Note down key details about the ending of the text. Why is it significant? How does the conclusion leave impact or resolution?

Key Quotations and Analysis			
Quotation	**Structural Feature**	**Effect / Meaning**	**Link to Theme or Reader Response**

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Literary Techniques

Identify significant examples of literary techniques, language features or stylistic devices that contribute to the mood and meaning of the text.

Technique	**Quotation**	**Effect**	**Link to Key Themes**

Personal Response

Personal Context Notes about your own identity and background (age, gender, ethnicity, life experiences etc.) that influence the way you view the world	**Response** How these factors influence your personal response to the text (consider connections with certain characters or events)

Did you enjoy the text? Why or why not?	
How did the text challenge, confirm or expand your thinking?	
Were the author's techniques effective in engaging or persuading you?	
What connections did you make while reading the text? • Does it relate to any of your personal experiences? • Does it remind you of any other similar texts you've read or viewed? • Can you link it to any real world events or issues?	